

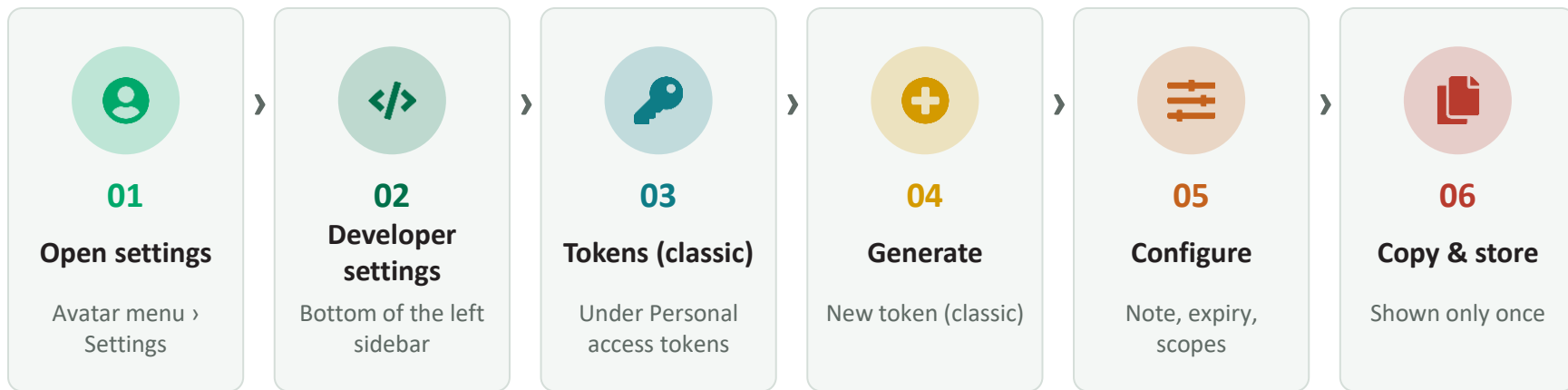
STG17 WORKSHOP · HANDS-ON GUIDE

Generate a GitHub API Key

Create a personal access token (classic) in six steps



From your profile to a working token



Treat the token like a password. A classic token can be used instead of your password for Git over HTTPS and to authenticate to the GitHub API.

Open your account menu



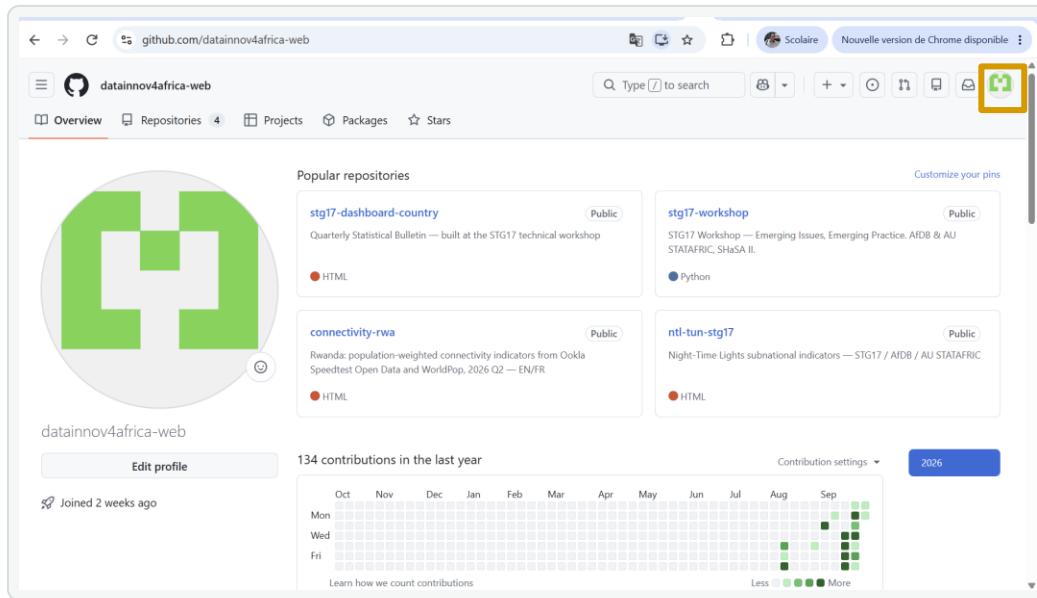
Sign in to GitHub

Go to github.com and sign in with your workshop account.



Click your avatar

Top-right corner of any GitHub page. It opens the account menu.



Screenshot: github.com — your profile page

Go to Settings



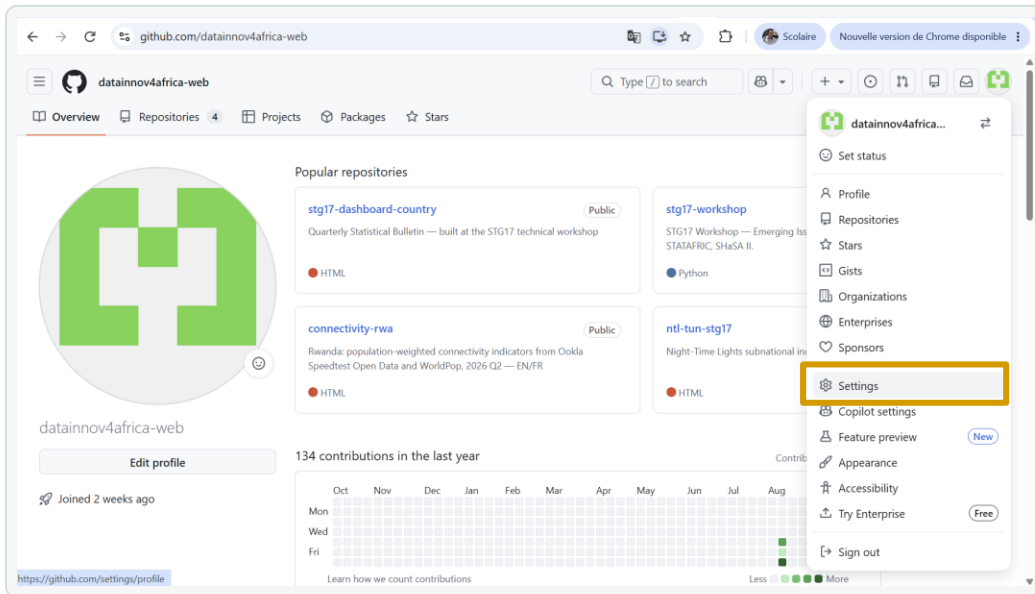
Scan the menu

It lists Profile, Repositories, Stars, Organizations and more.



Choose Settings

It opens your profile settings at github.com/settings/profile.



Screenshot: github.com — account menu

Open Developer settings



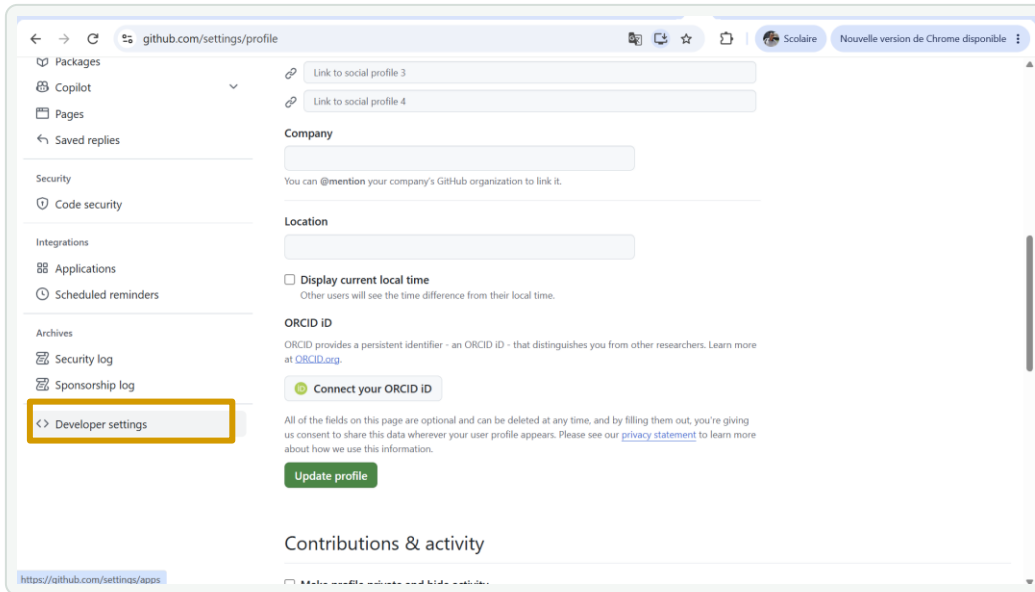
Scroll the left sidebar

Go all the way down, below the Archives section.



Click Developer settings

This is where GitHub Apps, OAuth Apps and access tokens live.



Screenshot: github.com/settings/profile

Select Tokens (classic)



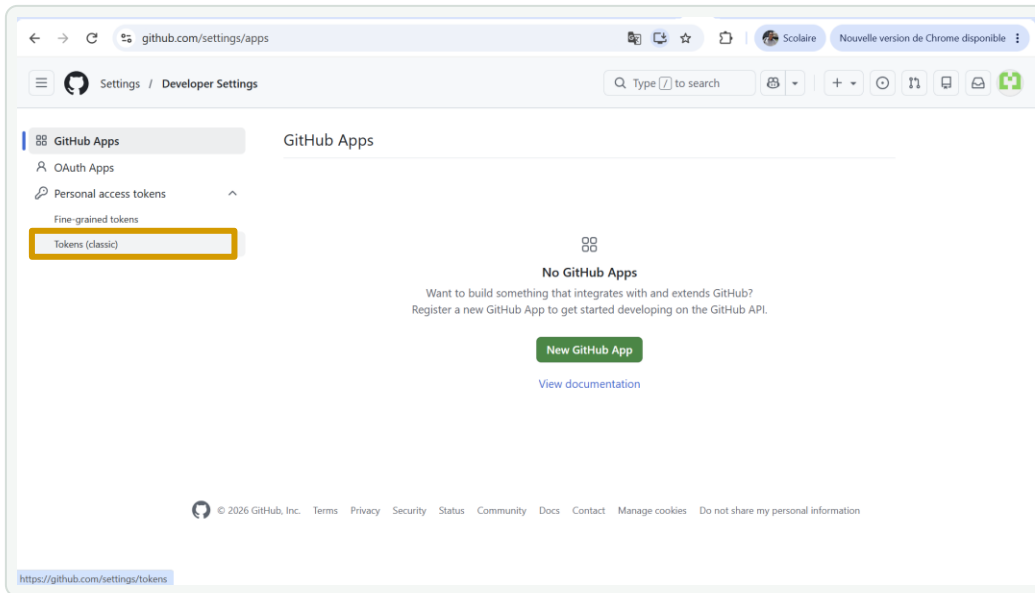
Expand Personal access tokens

Two options appear: Fine-grained tokens and Tokens (classic).



Click Tokens (classic)

The token type used in this workshop.



Screenshot: github.com/settings/apps

Generate a new classic token



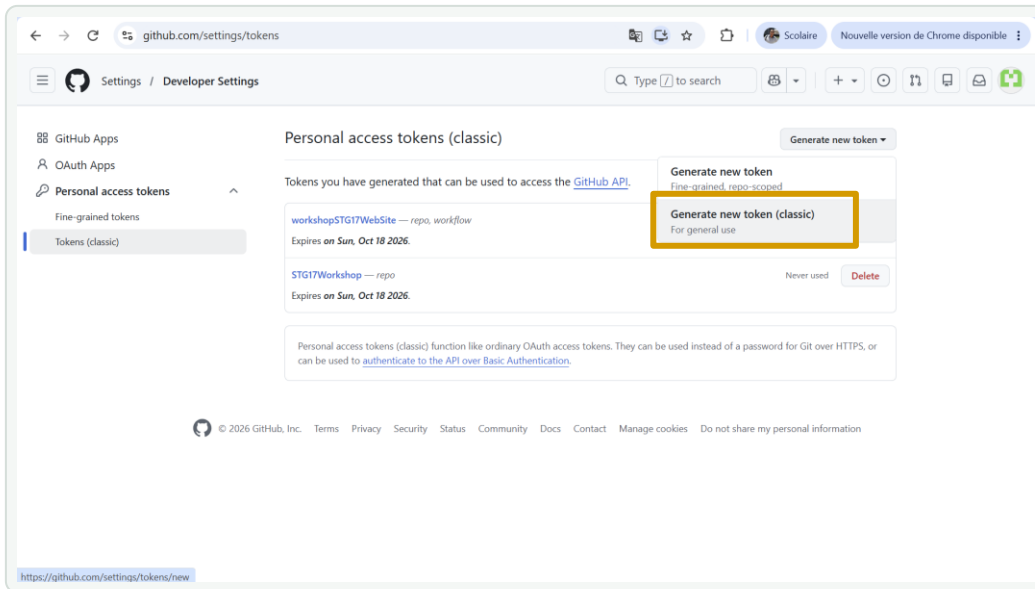
Open "Generate new token"

The dropdown button above your list of tokens.



Pick "Generate new token (classic)"

Labelled "For general use". GitHub may ask you to confirm your password.



Screenshot: github.com/settings/tokens

Name it, set expiry, pick scopes



Add a note

A name you will recognise, e.g. STG17WorkshopTest.



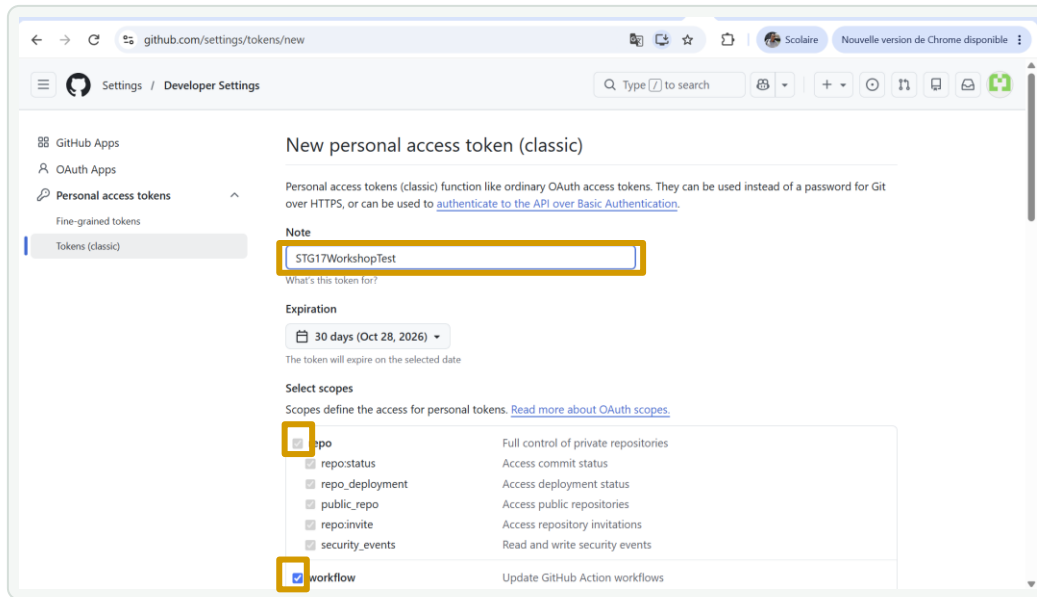
Set an expiration

30 days is enough for the workshop.



Tick repo and workflow

Then scroll down and click "Generate token".



Screenshot: github.com/settings/tokens/new

Copy your token now



Click the copy icon

Next to the new token, which starts with ghp_.

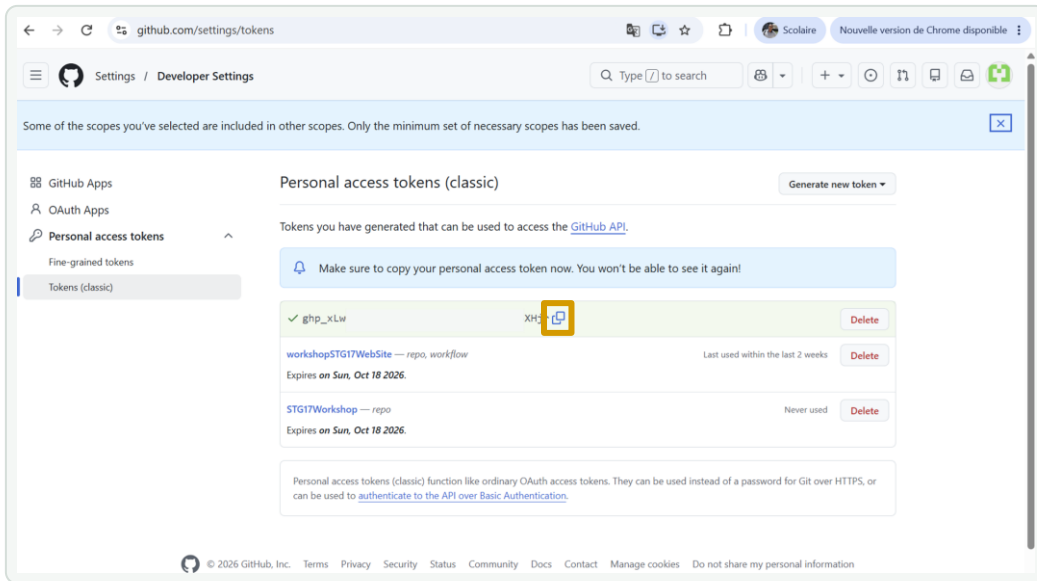


Store it safely

In a password manager or an environment variable.



You won't be able to see it again. If you lose it, generate a new one.



Screenshot: github.com/settings/tokens — token masked

Keep your token safe



Never commit it

Keep tokens out of code and repositories. Use an environment variable or a GitHub Actions secret.



Always set an expiry

Short-lived tokens limit the damage if one leaks. Regenerate when it expires.



Grant minimum scopes

Tick only the scopes your script needs. For this workshop: repo and workflow.



Revoke if exposed

Developer settings › Tokens (classic) › Delete, then generate a new token.

Source: GitHub Docs, "Managing your personal access tokens".

Sources



GitHub Docs — Managing your personal access tokens

docs.github.com/en/authentication/keeping-your-account-and-data-secure/managing-your-personal-access-tokens

Screenshots: github.com, captured with the datainnov4africa-web workshop account (token value masked).

YOU ARE READY

Your token unlocks the GitHub API